

Post-incident review PIR-2025-015

Customer Portal: failed sign-ins

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 28 August 2025, Customer Portal experienced failed sign-ins in production (AU East) for about 160 minutes. Staff in the contact centre noticed the console was slow and told the service owner. Investigation found that the client certificate used for the partner integration was not renewed.

Impact

Users of Customer Portal saw failed sign-ins for about 160 minutes. The service owner, Digital Channels, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:04 First signal received.
- 09:36 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:47 Likely cause identified.
- 10:00 Mitigation applied.
- 10:59 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the client certificate used for the partner integration was not renewed.

There was no documented procedure for this failure mode, so responders worked it out live.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.
- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.